

Summary message 30.12.2021

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Short „Summary“ of 30 December 2021 Message

Bright achievements in the last 25 years must be eclipsed by capacities we need to have acquired by the end of the new series of Plans

Work for the betterment of the world and live together in concord and harmony – 3 learning objectives: community building, social action, contributing to discourses of society releasing society-building powers of the Faith

Single aim: the release of the society-building power of the Faith in ever-greater measures 3 protagonists each have a part to play – not on their own, but by strengthening their dynamic relationships with one another

Gaining an ever more profound understanding of Bahá'u'lláh's teachings and applying them to the needs of society Power of the Cause is becoming increasingly visible

The movement of clusters

Advances in the process of entry by troops are necessary. Goal: establish intensive programmes of growth in all the clusters of the world needs broadening and intensification of activity

National Spiritual Assemblies and Regional Councils: determine whether schemes for dividing territories into clusters would benefit from adjustments

Movement of clusters along continuum of development will remain basic model for expansion and consolidation numbers need to be forecasted for the number of clusters passing the first, second and third milestones.

Learning about the acceleration of the growth process needs to reach every part of the world. Third milestone clusters: make swift acceleration of expansion and consolidation in surrounding clusters possible. Nine Year Plan: at least one third milestone cluster in every country and every region deployment of teams of international and homefront pioneers

Tremendous advance in the teaching work developed through participation in institute courses and practical experience Creating environment, that easily enables recognition of Bahá'u'lláh, not just of individuals, but of families, groups of friends and even clusters of households.

Help believers reflect on effective ways of teaching – ongoing process of learning

Learning from the most advanced clusters

Third milestone clusters: intense activity in neighbourhoods as well as concerted effort by generality of believers, community building, working in nuclei, widening circle of participation, reaching out to receptive populations, learning from each other and kindling within one another joy of teaching

Large numbers coordination becomes necessary. Collaborative arrangements among groups of families, informal network of friends, culture of worship and service, community gatherings (camps, festivals), importance of the arts, outward-looking orientation

New frontier: significant proportion of a population taking part in community-building activities Local Spiritual Assemblies strengthen relationships with authorities and local leaders, social action increases, multiple assistants each following one or more lines of action

In these places: inhabitants have increased capacity to steer course of own development, institutions and agencies: expanded vision of their responsibilities, Bahá'í community: highly visible protagonist in society release of society-building power of the Faith

Settings and circumstances are different, but challenge facing the friends is essentially the same reading reality and formulating learning objectives to pursue, identifying strategies, learning from more developed communities/clusters. Every community: goal, every goal: path to reach it

Contributing to social transformation

Transformation of humanity's inner life and social environment improving the spiritual character and social conditions of the wider community, esp. through building capacity for service

Consciousness of social, economic, or cultural barriers impeding progress grows. Expansion & consolidation, social action and contributions to discourses: dimensions of a single, unified, outward-looking endeavor coherence

Stirrings of grassroots social action in diverse fields, including environment, agriculture, health, the arts, and education. Local Assemblies need to learn to cultivate and foster initiatives, sometimes Bahá'í-inspired organizations will need to be formed. In some places, entities dedicated to following social action will be created by National Spiritual Assemblies.

Capacity for contributing to the discourses of society central to work of Bahá'í International Community and Offices of External Affairs. Often arises through closer association with a population through expansion & consolidation. Growth greater need for Bahá'í community (esp. the Local Spiritual Assembly) to offer perspective on obstacles to social progress in different settings and with different groups, leaders and figures of authority

Social action and efforts to participate in discourses: not just in context of growth, but also result of individual Bahá'ís striving to contribute to society's progress, e.g. in professional field or by supporting activities of like-minded groups and organizations. Projects and Bahá'í-inspired organizations have been established. Closely connected to activities and institutions.

Educational endeavours and the training institute

Significance of education in community building, pre-eminent: training institute which has already trained thousands of tutors, animators and children's class teachers resource of historic consequence

Before: training institute in the context of expansion & consolidation, now: more expansive view, ever-deeper engagement in the life of the wider community progress of society, institute is a potent means for the society-building power of the Faith to find release. Systems for preparing and refining educational materials need to be extended.

Raising capacity of the institutes enhancing quality and expanding system, advancing understanding of educational content Training institute boards are supported by collaborative groups and resource persons, Counsellors and Auxiliary Board Members: share learning experience across countries, regions and clusters Learning sites – fruitful collaboration with training institutes

Educational system in a state of constant refinement contribute to its advancement Sacred charge: releasing the potential of youth, vice versa youth should contribute to future development of institute Broad

movement of youth setting the standard encourage many souls to benefit from institute's programmes, offer period(s) of service cherished commitment to institute's activities

Consciousness of importance of education in all its forms engagement in the institute process by large numbers has gradually reshaped education within a population Institutions: need to take responsibility to support the noble aspirations in young people to acquire education and training necessary for life-long service to society

Understanding the significance of Bahá'u'lláh's Revelation: not limited to institute process continuous study of the Cause of Bahá'u'lláh individually and collectively, in formal spaces and in informal settings lifelong occupation Implications for countless fields of human endeavour notable example: ISGP

Community will need to explicate the principles it advocates and demonstrate their applicability to the issues facing humanity intellectual rigour and clarity of thought as well as commitment to spiritual and material progress

Raising capacity for administration at all levels

Shape of Bahá'í administration has developed considerably continued development will be essential for release of society-building power of the Faith

Development of Local Spiritual Assemblies – attaining certain level of capacity re. community-building endeavours cultivating appreciation for the formal aspects of community life associated with Bahá'í administration forming Assembly Responsibility: encourage and strengthen activities which help to sustain a vibrant community and wide range of other responsibilities support by auxiliaries and assistants necessary

Establishing and consolidating Local Spiritual Assemblies, possible changes of definition of boundaries

Appreciation of sacredness of electoral process and duty to participate in it recognition of station and leadership of Local Spiritual Assembly Raised consciousness about spiritual principles new conception re. service on institutions and interrelations between institutions and agencies Conversations about formation of Local Spiritual Assembly and its purpose strength of elected body and dynamism of community life reinforce each other

Two-stage electoral process for Local Spiritual Assemblies: division of locality into units election of delegates election of Local Spiritual Assembly Method will be adopted in many more places in the coming Plan

Local Spiritual Assembly: keen interest in learning how to best advance community-building work regular consultation with friends coordinating endeavours in the cluster, follows closely development of centres of intense activity, organizational arrangements Large communities: secretary of Assembly supported by staffed office local Hazíratu'l-Quds

Growing responsibility of Local Spiritual Assemblies institutions at regional and national level must become more systematic in support of Local Spiritual Assemblies

Regional Council with enhanced capacity for administration acceleration of progress of region In smaller countries appoint formal structure – National Growth Committee with 3, 5 or 7 members – at national level to help clusters advance fosters movement of clusters

Auxiliary Board Members preserve and fortify vitality of various lines of action in face of countervailing forces and assist friends to face different kinds of challenges and help them grow in faith, assurance, and commitment to a life of service, accompany them as they build communities as havens of peace

Sense of focus of community: has to accommodate many lines of action which all must advance without competition calls for expanded vision, nuanced understanding of coexisting imperatives, added flexibility, and heightened institutional collaboration

A historic mission

Capacity and discipline have prepared community for extensive, rigorous test of all its resources. Nine Year Plan demands similar to demands of the Ten Year Crusade

Keep perspective of history fully in view unfoldment of new order, establishment of Divine Civilization ("primary mission") foundational qualities: unity, trustworthiness, mutual support, collaboration, fellow feeling, selflessness, commitment to truth, a sense of responsibility, a thirst to learn, the love of an all-embracing heart

Longing for love and teaching, becoming more perfect channels of His grace